

🕒 BRAND AUDIT ✦ CASE STUDY

Chloe & Co

Full of Beans

A Community-Driven Brand Audit & Digital Experience Case Study

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🕒 More Than a Coffee Shop

When I first visited Chloe & Co Full of Beans in Dundalk, I expected to evaluate a café brand. **Instead, I walked into a space built around community, inclusion, and purpose and it completely changed the direction of this project.**

"Strong brands are not always built through advertising budgets. Sometimes they are built through consistency, compassion, and genuine community trust."

The café is connected to

Save Our Homeless Dundalk, a charity organisation supporting people experiencing homelessness and financial hardship in Dundalk and North Louth. The owner has been involved in charity and community support work for **more than 10 years**.

This audit became a study of how emotional branding, authenticity, and social purpose influence customer experience and digital perception.

📍 Project Overview

What I Set Out to Evaluate

- Digital presence & brand identity
- Customer experience & physical environment
- Social media communication strategy
- Google discoverability & local SEO
- Competitor benchmarking
- Local marketing opportunities

Why This Project Matters

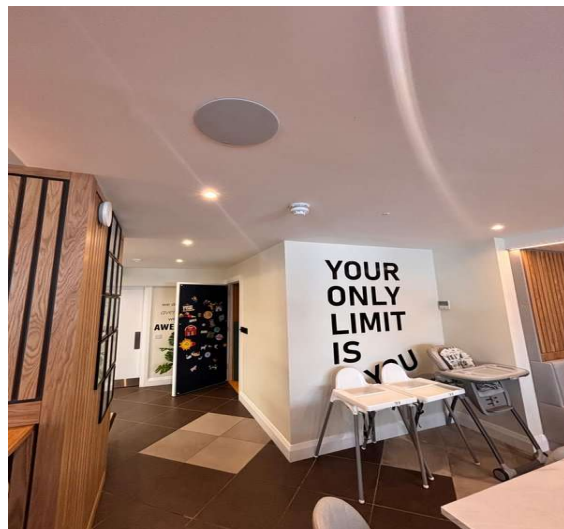
Chloe & Co is not just a café, it is a social enterprise that actively creates employment opportunities for people with disabilities. Understanding how its mission shapes customer perception became the emotional core of this audit.

✦ First Impressions & Café Experience

Walking into the café felt warm, calm, and welcoming. Several visual details immediately elevated the in-person brand experience:

- Minimalist modern interiors
- Motivational wall typography
- Warm, inviting lighting
- Approachable, welcoming staff
- Community-driven atmosphere

The café already aligns naturally with modern Gen Z café aesthetics, without trying too hard. It feels authentic because it genuinely is.



🌟 Social Media Audit

The café's content feels genuine and personal. However, compared to local competitors, digital visibility remains limited.

✅ Strengths

- ✓ Authentic food photography
- ✓ Warm and welcoming tone
- ✓ Community-driven messaging
- ✓ Real café atmosphere captured
- ✓ Strong emotional storytelling potential

⚡ Opportunities

- ✓ Inconsistent posting schedule
- ✓ Limited Reels / video content
- ✓ Low overall posting frequency
- ✓ Minimal storytelling in captions
- ✓ Low discoverability optimisation

🔍 Google Discoverability Audit

✅ Positive Findings

- ✓ Google Maps visibility
- ✓ Clear location information
- ✓ Existing local awareness
- ✓ Strong emotional branding

⚡ Key Weaknesses

- Website redirects to Instagram only
- No searchable online menu
- Limited Google review count
- Low image optimisation on Google
- Limited overall SEO visibility

Modern customers expect: menus online, strong visual discoverability, customer reviews, mobile-friendly browsing, and quick access to information. Currently, customers must search manually through Instagram posts.

📊 Competitor Benchmark

Business	Instagram	Google Reviews	Menu Online	Posting
Chloe & Co	141	8	No	Weekly
Competitor A	1,200	120	Yes	Daily
Competitor B	950	85	Yes	3x Weekly

Key Insight: The café's challenge is not authenticity, it is discoverability. Competitors perform better because they post consistently, optimise for search, and provide accessible information. **Chloe & Co already has the emotional advantage.**

Customer Journey Analysis



Inside vs. Online

The physical brand experience is significantly stronger than the digital experience.

Inside the café:

- ✓ Menu is visually clear and well-presented
- ✓ Products appear fresh and inviting
- ✓ Atmosphere supports comfort and connection
- ✓ Staff are warm and approachable

People who discover the café, love it. The challenge is helping more people discover it in the first place.

Strategic Recommendations

01

Create a Simple Website or Landing Page

- Include café story, menu, opening hours, and Google Maps integration
- Add accessibility information and community mission statement
- This will improve SEO and build immediate customer trust

02

Level Up the Instagram Strategy

- Post Reels, customer stories, and behind-the-scenes clips
- Highlight volunteer work, café atmosphere, and aesthetic food visuals
- Target 3–4 posts weekly for consistent visibility

03

Optimise the Google Business Profile

- Upload professional café photos and add full menu
- Use QR codes at tables to prompt customer Google reviews
- Engage with all existing reviews, positive and constructive

Lead With Emotional Storytelling as Core Strategy

- Most cafés compete on products, price, or aesthetics
- Chloe & Co competes on purpose, inclusion, and community trust
- This creates significantly stronger long-term customer loyalty



Final Reflection

"Chloe & Co already feels like a strong community brand. The next step is making that story easier for more people to discover."

Interviewing the owner and truly understanding the mission behind the café made this feel like more than a university project. As someone building a career in marketing analytics and consumer behaviour, this experience showed me how powerful authentic storytelling becomes when combined with the right digital strategy.

Skills Demonstrated

Brand Audit	Customer Experience	Digital Presence
Social Media Strategy	Competitor Benchmarking	Consumer Behaviour
Marketing Strategy	Local SEO Review	Qualitative Research